EU Integration Tracker
Accession, integration, treaties

European Integration Index

How far the European Union itself has integrated since 1952, from the customs union to a common defence, and which reforms are still missing.

Edition of October 2026



Data as of
19 October 2026

Method
29 reforms in six pillars of equal weight, scored from 0 to 100

Updates
Quarterly; next edition January 2027

Independent publication built from the Treaties and official EU sources, not an official document of the European Union or of any of its institutions. The list of reforms and the weights are our own choice and are published in full.

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Summary

The European Integration Index measures how far the Union itself is integrated, on a scale where 100 would be a fully integrated Union. Data as of 19 October 2026, identical to the EU Integration Tracker website.

57.5 / 100
INDEX, OCTOBER 2026
Up from 3.3 in 1952

11
REFORMS IN PLACE
of 29 tracked

11
PARTLY IN PLACE
Limited in scope, temporary or not in all member states

7
STILL MISSING
Including common defence and a single president

Key findings

- **Europe is still under construction.** With 11 of 29 reforms fully in place, the Union stands at 57.5 out of 100. The score has not changed since 2021, when common borrowing, the European Defence Fund and the European Public Prosecutor's Office started.
- **Treaties drove the biggest steps.** The largest jumps came with the Lisbon Treaty in 2009 (+15.8 points) and the Maastricht Treaty in 1993 (+10.8 points).
- **Citizens and rights is the most integrated pillar (75 out of 100)**; budget and fiscal capacity is the least integrated (40). The EU cannot set its own taxes and borrows only on a temporary basis.
- **Unanimity is the main brake.** It still applies to foreign and defence policy, taxation, the long-term budget, own resources, enlargement and every change to the Treaties.
- **Seven reforms are missing altogether:** capital markets union, taxes decided at EU level, permanent budget for economic stabilisation, right of initiative for Parliament, treaty changes without unanimity, a single president of the European Council and the Commission, common defence.

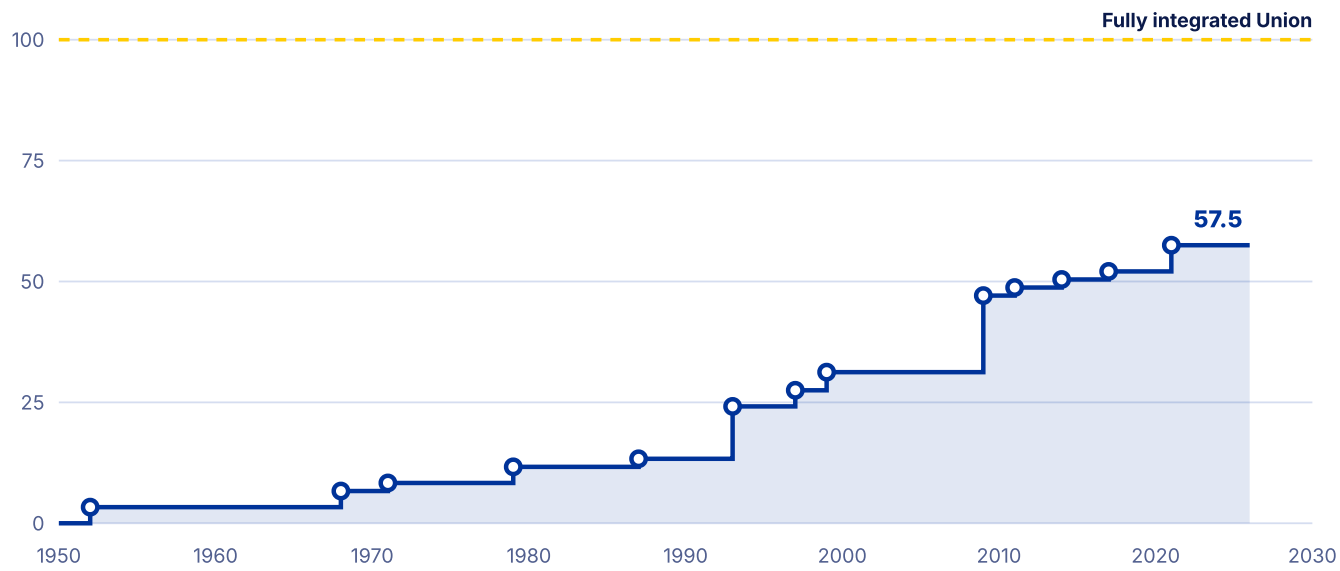
Score by pillar

Single market and currency	60
Budget and fiscal capacity	40
Decision-making	50
Executive and representation	70
Foreign policy, security and defence	50
Citizens and rights	75

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A project under construction

The index recalculated for every year since 1950 with today's method. Each step is a treaty or a reform that brought the Union closer to full integration; the dashed line is the end point, which has not been reached.



The steps

YEAR	REFORMS THAT ENTERED INTO FORCE OR STARTED	INDEX
1952	Independent supranational executive	**3.3**
1968	Customs union	**6.7**
1971	Own resources	**8.3**
1979	Directly elected Parliament	**11.7**
1987	Majority voting instead of unanimity	**13.3**
1993	Single market, Parliament as co-legislator, Common foreign and security policy, EU citizenship	**24.2**
1997	Common fiscal rules	**27.5**
1999	Single currency, Schengen area in EU law	**31.2**
2009	Parliament as co-legislator, Permanent President of the European Council, Commission President linked to European elections, Foreign policy chief and diplomatic service, Mutual assistance clause, Binding Charter of Fundamental Rights	**47.1**
2011	Foreign policy chief and diplomatic service	**48.8**
2014	Banking union	**50.4**
2017	Permanent structured cooperation (PESCO)	**52.1**
2021	Common borrowing, EU funding for defence, European Public Prosecutor's Office	**57.5**

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What is still missing

The 18 reforms that are missing or only partly in place, starting with those not in place at all.

SINGLE MARKET AND CURRENCY · MISSING

Capital markets union

Capital markets remain largely national. The Savings and Investments Union is a set of proposals still under way.

BUDGET AND FISCAL CAPACITY · MISSING

Taxes decided at EU level

The EU cannot set its own taxes. New own resources need unanimity in the Council and approval in every member state (Article 311 TFEU).

BUDGET AND FISCAL CAPACITY · MISSING

Permanent budget for economic stabilisation

There is no permanent EU fiscal capacity to absorb economic shocks.

DECISION-MAKING · MISSING

Right of initiative for Parliament

Only the Commission can propose laws. Parliament can ask it to act but cannot table proposals itself.

DECISION-MAKING · MISSING

Treaty changes without unanimity

Every treaty change must be ratified by all member states (Article 48 TEU).

EXECUTIVE AND REPRESENTATION · MISSING

A single President of the European Council and the Commission

The two posts are separate and filled by different procedures (Articles 15 and 17 TEU).

FOREIGN POLICY, SECURITY AND DEFENCE · MISSING

Common defence

The Treaty foresees a common defence, but it needs a unanimous decision of the European Council and approval in every member state (Article 42(2) TEU). There is no EU army.

SINGLE MARKET AND CURRENCY · PARTLY IN PLACE

Single currency

The euro has existed since 1999, but only 21 of the 27 member states use it.

SINGLE MARKET AND CURRENCY · PARTLY IN PLACE

Banking union

Single supervision by the ECB (2014) and single resolution (2016) are in place. The European deposit insurance scheme is still only a proposal.

BUDGET AND FISCAL CAPACITY · PARTLY IN PLACE

Own resources

Since 1971 the budget has been financed by own resources, but the largest of them is a contribution based on each country's national income.

BUDGET AND FISCAL CAPACITY · PARTLY IN PLACE

Common borrowing

The EU borrowed on the markets for NextGenerationEU from 2021 and for the SAFE defence loans from 2025, but only on a temporary basis.

DECISION-MAKING · PARTLY IN PLACE

Majority voting instead of unanimity

Qualified majority voting has spread since the Single European Act, but unanimity remains for foreign and defence policy, taxation, the long-term budget, own resources and enlargement.

EXECUTIVE AND REPRESENTATION · PARTLY IN PLACE

Commission President linked to European elections

Since 2009 the European Council proposes the candidate taking into account the European elections, and Parliament elects him or her (Article 17 TEU). Leaders keep the choice.

FOREIGN POLICY, SECURITY AND DEFENCE · PARTLY IN PLACE

Common foreign and security policy

Created by the Maastricht Treaty in 1993. Decisions still need unanimity.

FOREIGN POLICY, SECURITY AND DEFENCE · PARTLY IN PLACE

Permanent structured cooperation (PESCO)

Set up in December 2017. 26 member states take part; Malta does not.

FOREIGN POLICY, SECURITY AND DEFENCE · PARTLY IN PLACE

EU funding for defence

The European Defence Fund (2021) and the SAFE loans of up to EUR 150 billion (2025) finance defence industry projects, but defence spending stays national.

CITIZENS AND RIGHTS · PARTLY IN PLACE

Schengen area in EU law

Brought into EU law by the Amsterdam Treaty in 1999. 25 of the 27 member states are full members; Cyprus is not yet and Ireland has an opt-out.

CITIZENS AND RIGHTS · PARTLY IN PLACE

European Public Prosecutor's Office

Operational since 2021. 25 of the 27 member states take part; Denmark and Ireland do not.

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All reforms tracked

Each reform scores 1 when in place for the EU as a whole, 0.5 when partly in place and 0 when missing. Each pillar is the average of its reforms; the index is the average of the six pillars.

REFORM	STATUS	SINCE
SINGLE MARKET AND CURRENCY · 60 / 100		
Customs union	In place	1968
Single market	In place	1993
Single currency	Partly	1999
Banking union	Partly	2014
Capital markets union	Missing	–
BUDGET AND FISCAL CAPACITY · 40 / 100		
Own resources	Partly	1971
Common fiscal rules	In place	1997
Common borrowing	Partly	2021
Taxes decided at EU level	Missing	–
Permanent budget for economic stabilisation	Missing	–
DECISION-MAKING · 50 / 100		
Directly elected Parliament	In place	1979
Parliament as co-legislator	In place	2009
Majority voting instead of unanimity	Partly	1987
Right of initiative for Parliament	Missing	–
Treaty changes without unanimity	Missing	–
EXECUTIVE AND REPRESENTATION · 70 / 100		
Independent supranational executive	In place	1952
Permanent President of the European Council	In place	2009
Commission President linked to European elections	Partly	2009
Foreign policy chief and diplomatic service	In place	2011
A single President of the European Council and the Commission	Missing	–
FOREIGN POLICY, SECURITY AND DEFENCE · 50 / 100		
Common foreign and security policy	Partly	1993
Mutual assistance clause	In place	2009
Permanent structured cooperation (PESCO)	Partly	2017
EU funding for defence	Partly	2021
Common defence	Missing	–
CITIZENS AND RIGHTS · 75 / 100		
EU citizenship	In place	1993
Binding Charter of Fundamental Rights	In place	2009
Schengen area in EU law	Partly	1999
European Public Prosecutor's Office	Partly	2021

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Methodology

The European Integration Index is our own score. Every status is checked against the Treaties and official EU sources, listed in the sources section.

Rules and limits

- The index covers 29 reforms in six pillars of equal weight. The list and the weights are our choice and are published so that anyone can check or contest them.
- Full integration is used here as a reference point, not as a goal that the Union should reach. The index does not judge whether a reform is desirable.
- A reform counts as partly in place when it is limited in scope, temporary, or applies only to some member states.
- The historical curve applies today's method to past years, so it shows the order and size of the steps rather than how contemporaries saw them.
- Statuses are checked against the Treaties and official EU sources.

Release calendar

- **Quarterly editions:** January, April, July and October. The next edition is due in January 2027.
- **Extra updates** when a reform tracked by the index is adopted or enters into force.

The current debate

22 NOV 2023 · EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT

Proposals to amend the Treaties

Parliament proposed more qualified majority voting, a right of legislative initiative and a defence union, and asked for a Convention under Article 48 TEU. The European Council has not called one.

6 OCT 2026 · EUROPEAN COMMISSION

Preparing for a wider Union

The Commission's pre-enlargement reviews propose using existing treaty tools, such as passerelle clauses and qualified majority voting in selected areas, rather than treaty change.

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Sources

Each reform is checked against the Treaties or an official EU source. Links checked on 19 October 2026.

European Union website
Founding agreements: Treaties of Paris, Rome, the Single European Act, Maastricht, Amsterdam, Nice and Lisbon
https://european-union.europa.eu/principles-countries-history/principles-and-values/founding-agreements_en

EUR-Lex
Consolidated Treaty on European Union (Articles 15, 17, 31, 42 and 48)
https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/treaty/teu_2016/oj

European Commission, via CVCE
Declaration on the completion of the customs union, 1 July 1968
https://www.cvce.eu/obj/declaration_by_the_commission_of_the_european_communities_1_july_1968-en-a4f5b96a-1d48-435b-9028-7e98739255d2.html

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https://finance.ec.europa.eu/publications/market-integration-package_en

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Council Decision of 21 April 1970 on own resources
https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/dec/1970/243/oj/eng

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https://economy-finance.ec.europa.eu/economic-and-fiscal-governance/eu-assessment-and-monitoring-national-economic-policies/evolution-eu-economic-governance/new-economic-governance-framework_en

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Council Decision (EU, Euratom) 2020/2053 on own resources
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Council of the EU
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https://www.consilium.europa.eu/en/policies/financing-the-eu-budget/

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Fact sheet: historical background of the European Parliament
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https://www.eeas.europa.eu/eeas/about-european-external-action-service_en

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https://www.pesco.europa.eu/about/

European Commission
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https://www.eppo.europa.eu/en/about/members

EUR-Lex
European Parliament resolution of 22 November 2023 on proposals to amend the Treaties
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Questions and answers on the pre-enlargement policy reviews, 6 October 2026
https://enlargement.ec.europa.eu/news/questions-and-answers-pre-enlargement-policy-reviews-2026-10-06_en

EUR-Lex
Regulation (EU) 2021/697 establishing the European Defence Fund
https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2021/697/oj/eng

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